

Acme Cloud Operations Manual

1. Standard Deployment Rule

Production services may be deployed after automated tests pass, the service owner approves the release, and the deployment window is open. A deployment is considered approved when all three conditions are satisfied.

2. Deployment Windows

The normal production deployment window is Monday through Thursday, 09:00–17:00 UTC. Friday deployments require additional authorization.

Release Authorization

3. Emergency Deployments

An emergency deployment may bypass the normal deployment window when a service is actively causing customer impact. The incident commander must approve the deployment and an incident ticket must exist before deployment begins.

4. Audit Requirement

Every production deployment must have an audit record containing the deployer, timestamp, service name, and approval reference.

Access Control

5. Standard Access

Employees requesting production database access must have manager approval and must use a company-managed device. Access expires after 30 days unless renewed.

6. Temporary Access

Temporary access may be granted for up to 72 hours without manager approval when required to resolve an active production incident. The incident commander must approve it.

Data Handling

7. Customer Data

Customer records may be exported only to approved storage. Exports containing more than 10,000 customer records require security approval.

8. Encryption

All customer-data exports must use encryption in transit. Exports containing payment information must also use encryption at rest.

Service Changes

9. Configuration Changes

Configuration changes require peer review before production rollout. Changes made through the emergency incident procedure do not require peer review before rollout, but the review must be completed within 2 business days.

10. Rollback

A rollback performed during an active incident is treated as an emergency change. The rollback must still be recorded in the deployment audit log.

Exception Register

11. Exception A — Critical Security Patch

A critical security patch may be deployed outside the normal deployment window even when there is no customer impact. It requires approval from the security lead and the service owner. The emergency-deployment rule in Section 3 does not apply to this exception.

12. Exception B — Read-Only Database Access

Read-only production database access for troubleshooting may be granted for up to 7 days with manager approval. The 30-day expiration rule in Section 5 therefore does not apply to read-only access.

Incident Procedures

13. Incident Commander Authority

During a declared Severity-1 incident, the incident commander may authorize emergency deployments, temporary production access, and emergency configuration changes. However, this authority does not override the critical-security-patch approval requirements in Section 11.

14. Post-Incident Review

All emergency actions must be reviewed after the incident. Deployment audit records must be complete before the incident is closed.

Policies and Cross-References

15. Conflicting-Looking Rules

The normal deployment rule requires an open deployment window, but Section 3 permits emergency deployments outside that window. Section 11 is a separate exception for critical security patches and has its own approval requirements.

16. Decision Procedure

When multiple rules appear applicable, first determine whether an explicit exception applies. If an exception specifies its own approval requirements, those requirements take precedence over the general rule. If no exception applies, use the normal rule.

17. Example Scenario

A critical security patch is discovered at 22:00 UTC on Friday. There is no customer impact. The service owner approves the patch, but the security lead has not approved it. Under this manual, the patch must not be deployed yet because the specific requirements in Section 11 have not been satisfied.